

A final way to make a copy of a file on the same disk is to simply copy the file to another disk, then back to the original disk, and finally delete the temporary copy from the second disk. Often this is the long way around, but if your system contains a RAM Disk, you may actually find it the fastest and most convenient way.

The Trash

The Trash is used to remove files and folders from your disks. Think of the trash as a holding place for things you want to get rid of. The items aren't deleted immediately, but are instead held in the trash for a while to give you a chance to change your mind. When the trash has something in it, it bulges (Figure 6M).



Figure 6M—The Bulging Trash Can

The trash is emptied automatically when you copy or move a file, when you launch a program or open a document, or when you shut down using the "Shut Down" option on the Special menu. You can also empty it manually with the "Empty Trash" option under Special.

If you decide you don't want to delete a file you put in the Trash, you can open the Trash like any other icon by double-clicking it. Select the items you changed your mind about and select "Put Away" from the File menu. The files will return to their original folders and disks. Alternately, you can drag them to where they belong if you don't want to return them to their original locations.

Note!

If you turn off the computer's power before the Finder empties the trash (i.e., if you don't use the "Shut Down" option), the contents of the trash return to their original windows.

Files On The Desktop

It's possible to drag files *out* of their windows and deposit them on the Finder's desktop. The Finder will remember the positions and coloring of these icons, so they'll stay there until you want them to go away. By doing this with frequently-used files and folders, you can streamline how you work with your disks in the Finder.

Prime candidates for desktop icons include your most frequently used programs, like AppleWorks or AppleWorks GS, plus any other programs you use more than occasionally. Placing a folder on the desktop allows easy access to the entire contents of the folder with just a double-click. By placing files and folders on the desktop, you can turn the Finder into a customized program launcher that rivals most commercial packages.

Since the Finder places your disk icons on the right side of the screen, most users place their other desktop icons on the left side of the screen or along the bottom.